

CATHY T. RIES

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SR. TECHNICAL **PRODUCT MANAGER**

Product Manager with extensive experience working across technical and functional roles. Recent work has focused on applying artificial intelligence (AI) to digital e-commerce experiences. **Product** work includes building prototypes, backend platforms, and consumer facing applications using **agile** methodologies.

KEY AREAS OF EXPERTISE

SaaS Platforms | A/B Testing | Roadmap Development | User Research | Analytics

WORK EXPERIENCE

MICROSOFT, Seattle, WA

November 2020 – January 2025

Sr. Technical **Product Manager, E-Commerce Search**

Launched new Microsoft digital stores search experience to increase customer engagement and improve relevancy in collaboration with research, UX, experimentation, **marketing**, and engineering teams. Search impacted several millions of customers per day.

- Launched A/B tests with Experimentation team to inform new UX for search results pages and autosuggest/search bar capabilities on digital stores website.
- Participated in technical investigations with developers in backend replatforming work to enable additional indexing and allow integration of AI solutions (Azure AI Search) to improve search result relevancy.
- Drafted wireframes and flows to showcase new feature behavior for search bar functionality and search results pages. Worked with Design team to convert to high fidelity mockups used for A/B testing and feature development.
- Owned **product** roadmap, defined/tracked feature metrics for user engagement, wrote feature requirements, led user acceptance testing/bug triage, managed timelines, and showcased work to stakeholders across multiple levels of leadership.
- Researched competitors and market trends. Partnered with Research team to conduct interviews and launch surveys to collect customer feedback.

Sr. Technical **Product Manager, Digital Stores Commerce Platforms**

Supported systems and platforms that power Microsoft **retail** stores (www.microsoft.com) to enable seamless purchasing, browsing, and customer support.

- Developed proof of concept shopping app, including driving cross functional collaboration, managing timelines, feature prioritization, and feature deployment across multiple sprints.
- Owned 2nd iteration development of reservation platform to enable 100+ digital stores associates to provide new 1-on-1 virtual consultation services to Customers for shopping and support.
- Led content **management** platform deprecation initiative impacting 700+ websites, 10K+ internal customers, and several million external customers. Functioned as main point of contact driving timelines, defining work scope, managing communications to stakeholders, mitigating risks/blockers, and presenting work to executives.

ACCENTURE, Seattle, WA

January 2014 – August 2020

Strategy and Management Consultant

Advise and manage relationships with clients to implement critical solutions leveraging research, analytics, and industry insights to lead, design, and execute on special projects across a wide variety of industries.

- **Product Manager:** Owned end-to-end **product lifecycle** for delivering first iteration of internally-built **marketing** automation platform for e-commerce client.
 - Defined **product** goals and feature needs/ wants with stakeholders by leading discovery activities.
 - Owned **product** roadmap, functional specifications, feature prioritization, delivery schedule, stakeholder communications, and feature backlog **management** using JIRA.
 - Worked cross functionally with **business** and engineering teams across 3 **time** zones to deliver features in 2-week sprints using **agile** methodologies.
- **Change Management Lead:** Owned planning and implementing customer engagement program to drive user adoption for new SaaS platform (SAP Ariba, S/4 HANA) launch impacting over 100K customers at aerospace client.
 - Responsible for developing training plan, stakeholder **communication** strategy, customer support plan, and customer feedback channels.
 - Collaborated with engineering team to assess technical considerations and integrations required to create training sandbox.
 - Assessed future state impacts to multiple personas, including external and internal customers.

Technology Consulting Analyst

Implemented technology solutions via **agile** and waterfall methodologies for clients across multiple industries.

- Led testing team and deployment efforts at utility client for software **implementation**, including creating design documents, writing test scripts, testing system, tracking user engagement metrics, and facilitating releases to launch platform impacting 1K+ utility workers.
- Analyzed user engagement using data pulled from SQL database.

EDUCATION

Continuing Studies – Product Management in the Artificial Intelligence Era
Stanford University, Stanford, CA

Master of Science (MS) in Biomedical Engineering
University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA

Bachelor of Arts (BA) in Integrative Biology, French (Double Major)
University of California, Berkeley, Berkeley, CA

Cathy Ries

- Seattle, WA, US

Contact Information

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Summary

Accomplished strategy and **management** consultant with extensive experience creating digital products and driving customer adoption to emerging technology platforms. Works cross functionally with engineering and **business** teams to assess, strategize, and execute initiatives. Excels in understanding complex issues, translating technical language to **business** teams, creating human centered products, and leveraging data to identify opportunities and drive decisions that best serves customers. CLOUD AND/OR SAAS SOLUTION EXPERIENCE: Internal technology platforms, Adobe **Marketing** Cloud, Sitecore, Oracle (Utilities Network **Management** Systems, Value Chain Planning), ClickSchedule, Openlink Endur, SAP (S4 HANA, Ariba, Work and Asset **Management**, Master Data Governance, FIORI, Hybris)

Work History

Total Work Experience: 11 years

- **Sr. Technical **Product Manager**, Digital Stores Commerce Microsoft**
Nov 01, 2020
- ****Management** Consultant Accenture**
Feb 01, 2016
- **Technology Consulting Analyst Accenture**
Jan 01, 2014

Education

- **Masters** | University of Southern California
- **Bachelors** | University of California, Berkeley

Skills

- backlog **management** - 11 years
- feature engineering - 11 years
- **product management** - 11 years
- software as a service - 11 years
- software development methodology - 11 years
- **agile** - 9 years
- functional specifications - 9 years
- market research - 9 years
- **product** backlog - 9 years
- roadmap development - 9 years
- e-commerce - 8 years
- content **management** systems - 7 years
- data analytics - 7 years
- design documentation - 7 years
- **marketing** automation - 7 years
- ab testing - 5 years
- artificial intelligence - 4 years
- **agile** and waterfall methodologies
- **agile** application development
- **agile** methodologies
- analysis
- **business** analysis
- **business** analytics
- **business** impact analysis
- **business** requirements
- **business** strategy
- change **management**
- cloud applications
- **communication**
- customer experience **management**
- data analysis
- defining **product** requirements
- design documents
- design thinking
- digital transformation
- event planning

- feature prioritization
- hp **quality** center
- html
- information technology
- large scale system integration
- **management** consulting
- microsoft excel
- microsoft office
- microsoft word
- oracle **business** intelligence
- oracle utilities network **management**
- performance metrics
- powerpoint
- **product** adoption
- **product** launch
- **product** lifecycle management
- **product** road mapping
- program **management**
- project **management**
- requirements analysis
- requirements gathering
- research
- saas development
- sap
- scaled **agile** framework
- **senior** stakeholder **management**
- stakeholder engagement
- stakeholder **management**
- stakeholder workshops
- storytelling
- strategic consulting
- strategic planning
- strategic roadmaps
- system deployment
- technical requirements gathering
- technology adoption
- technology **product** development
- technology roadmapping
- testing
- training
- training and development
- user adoption
- **product** owner - 12 years
- user acceptance testing - 11 years
- lean six sigma - 2 years

Work Preferences

- Desired Work Settings: Remote or Hybrid
- Likely to Switch: True
- Willing to Relocate: False
- Travel Preference: 0%
- Work Authorization:
 - US
- Work Documents:
 - US Citizen
- Security Clearance: False
- Desired Salary: 180,000+ (USD)
- Third Party: False
- Employment Type:
 - Full-time
 - Contract to Hire - W2

Profile Sources

- linkedin: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/cathy-ries>
- facebook: <https://facebook.com/cathytliu>
- Dice: <https://www.dice.com/employer/talent/profile/c2792fe792fbdef5f351d17806c4004d>